

The RFCS is an ongoing Australian Government program. It provides free and independent financial counselling to eligible farmers, fishers, foresters and small related businesses experiencing, or at risk of, financial hardship.

The overarching goal of the RFCS program is to build financially capable agricultural, fishing and forestry sectors that are profitable, financially self-reliant and better prepared to deal with risks.

Using a case management approach the Program aims to:

- transition clients out of financial crisis
- improve clients' financial well-being and resilience
- improve clients' business profitability or facilitate a dignified exit through sale or succession.

The [Program Logic](#), [Program Logic infographic](#), [Guidelines](#) and the [Monitoring Evaluation and Assurance Framework](#) are integral to the RFCS Program and vision.

The Australian Government is investing over \$123 million (GST exclusive) in Program funding from 2021 until June 2027.

Services

Free and confidential services are provided by qualified rural financial counsellors who will use case management to help empower you to engage in strategic business and financial decision-making to improve your financial situation.

They will listen to your financial problems and provide support unique to you.

They can help you:

- understand your financial position through developing budgets and cash flows to enable you to re-assess the viability of your business
- develop an action plan and take the necessary steps to get you out of financial difficulty
- negotiate with your lenders
- build your financial knowledge, skills and resilience so you can manage potential challenges in the future.
- through limited transactional support to identify and assist you to apply for other government programs and assistance that will support the path back to self-sufficiency, including [Farm Household Allowance](#).

Counsellors will guide you through the process. You are always in control of the decision making.

Rural financial counsellors cannot give you advice relating to specific (branded) products, agribusiness, law, family or social issues, mental health or financial advice. They can refer you to other professional services for this assistance as part of their holistic approach.

This video features a farmer discussing the positive impact working with a rural financial counsellor has had on his business – you can view the video in the link below.

This video was produced by Services Australia.

As part of the Farm Household Allowance, we have regular appointments with a rural financial counsellor. It's been great to have someone beside you in the tough times that knows your story, and to go through an event with someone like that, and also planning with someone like that is great.

He's super encouraging, but also very knowledgeable. And so we usually leave with a bit of a plan, but usually feeling better about what we're doing and what we've done.

RFCS locations

Rural financial counsellors are located in agricultural communities in [12 RFCS provider regions](#) across Australia.

Find your local RFCS

NSW – Rural Financial Counselling Service contact details

There are two service providers that employ rural financial counsellors in New South Wales. To locate your nearest rural financial counsellor, contact the service provider's head office below.

NSW Northern

PO Box 54
Lismore NSW 2480

Level 1, Suite 2
75 Magellan Street
Lismore NSW 2480

Phone: [1800 344 090](tel:1800344090)
Fax: 02 6662 4105
Email: info@rfcsnr.org.au
Website: www.rfcsnr.org.au

NSW Southern and NSW Central

Phone: [1800 319 458](tel:1800319458)
Email: info@rfcsnsw.com.au
Website: www.rfcsnsw.com.au

Address details

PO Box 761
Cooma NSW 2630
137 Macquarie Street
Dubbo NSW 2830
Phone: [02 6434 4991](tel:0264344991)
104 Baylis Street
Wagga Wagga NSW 2650

Queensland – Rural Financial Counselling Service contact details

There are two service providers that employ rural financial counsellors in Queensland. To locate your nearest rural financial counsellor, contact the service provider's head office below.

Northern Region

PO Box 592
Longreach QLD 4730
100 Galah Street
Longreach QLD 4730

Phone: [07 4652 5669](tel:0746525669)
Fax: 07 4622 5500
Email: ceo@rfcsnq.com.au
Website: www.rfcsnq.com.au

Southern Region

PO Box 433
Roma QLD 4455

42B Wyndham Street
Roma QLD 4455

Rural financial counselling

Phone: [07 4622 5500](tel:0746225500)
Email: admin@rfcssq.org.au
Website: www.rfcssq.org.au

Small business financial counselling

Phone: [1300 732 777](tel:1300732777)
Email: info@sbfcssq.org.au
Website: www.sbfcssq.org.au

South Australia - Northern Territory – Rural Financial Counselling Service contact details

To locate your nearest rural financial counsellor, contact the service provider's head office below.

555 The Parade
Magill SA 5072

Phone: 1800 836 211
Email: enquiries@ruralbusinesssupport.org.au
Website: www.ruralbusinesssupport.org.au

Tasmania – Rural Financial Counselling Service contact details

To locate your nearest rural financial counsellor, contact the service provider's head office below.

22 Brisbane Street
Launceston TAS 7250

Phone: 1300 88 FARM (1300 88 3276)
Email: admin@ruralbusiness Tasmania.org.au
Website: www.ruralbusiness Tasmania.org.au

Victoria – Rural Financial Counselling Service contact details

There are three service providers that employ rural financial counsellors in Victoria. To locate your nearest rural financial counsellor, contact the service provider's head office below.

Victoria Eastern Region

PO Box 362
Leongatha VIC 3953

1 Peart Street
Leongatha VIC 3953

Phone: 1300 045 747
Email: support@rfcsgippsland.org.au
Website: www.ruralfinancialcounselling.org.au

Victoria North Eastern Region

102 Hume Street
Wodonga VIC 3690

PO Box 1619
Wodonga VIC 3689

Phone: 1300 834 775
Fax: 02 6100 6123
Email: info@agbizassist.org.au
Website: <https://www.rfcsvicne.org.au>

Victoria West Region

PO Box 715
Hamilton VIC 3300

77 Kennedy Street
Hamilton VIC 3300

Phone: 1300 735 578
Email: admin@wswrcs.com.au
Website: <https://wswrcs.com.au>

To locate your nearest rural financial counsellor, contact the service provider's head office below.

Western Australia – Rural Financial Counselling Service contact details

PO Box 919
Jurien Bay WA 6516

Phone: 1800 612 004
Email: enquiries@ruralwest.com.au
Website: <https://www.ruralwest.com.au>

Downloads

Contact

If you are unsure which RFCS region you are in, you can call the RFCS Network's national information line on 1300 771 741 which will connect you with your nearest RFCS office.

Background

The Australian Government has funded the RFCS in regional communities since 1986, in response to increased financial difficulties across the rural sector.

On 28 April 2021, the Australian Government announced successful applicants to deliver services across 12 predefined service regions under the 2021 to 2024 RFCS Program. This grant process was merit-based, open and competitive. These successful applicants have been granted an extension of funding until 30 June 2026. Further information is available on the [Community Grants Hub website](#).

The RFCS is jointly funded by the Australian, state and territory governments.

RFCS reviews

The RFCS has been [regularly reviewed](#). In 2019 the department conducted an internal review of the operation and structure of the 2016 to 2020 RFCS Program. The review made recommendations to improve client outcomes and the performance of RFCS providers. These recommendations were implemented in the [2021 to 2024 RFCS Program](#).

More support

Read more about [drought, disaster and rural support options](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/ag-farm-food/drought/assistance/rural-financial-counselling-service>